PLAYER TOOLKIT / 06

BODY TOOLS GUIDE

The recovery tools, supplements, and routines I use to support performance through a long professional season.

A field guide by Elijah Bryant.
Build the foundation before buying the tools.

THE RECOVERY HIERARCHY

NO GADGET CAN REPLACE THE BASICS.

The best recovery tools are still the simplest ones: whole foods, quality sleep, hydration, and a training plan your body can recover from. If those are missing, no supplement or machine will save you.

I still believe in looking for a one-percent edge. Over a long season, small advantages can add up. The key is to use tools as support for a strong routine, not as a substitute for one.

1. FOUNDATION

Sleep, food, hydration, movement, and an honest workload.

2. TARGET

Choose a tool for a specific need, not because it looks professional.

3. REPEAT

The useful routine is the one you can follow through travel and games.

MASTER THE NINETY-NINE PERCENT. THEN EARN THE ONE-PERCENT EDGE.

MY RULE: Start with the smallest stack that solves the problem. Add only what you can explain, afford, travel with, and use consistently.

PERSONAL ROUTINE

SUPPORT THE DAY BEFORE IT GETS BUSY.

WHAT I USE	MY PURPOSE	HOW IT FITS MY ROUTINE
FloraSport 20B	Gut + immune support	A probiotic I use on an empty stomach, especially when travel disrupts food and routine.
Kion Flex	Joint support	Part of my morning routine during long stretches of practices, flights, and games.
Kion Aminos or EAAs	Protein support	A convenient option when my schedule makes it harder to get a full meal immediately.
Mitopure	Cellular-energy support	A longevity-focused supplement I take with breakfast.
Omega-3	General health support	I take it with food as part of a broader nutrition plan.
Creatine	Power + training support	A simple daily habit. Consistency matters more than perfect timing.
Redmond Re-Lyte	Hydration	Useful when I sweat heavily, travel, or need help replacing electrolytes.

FOOD FIRST. SUPPLEMENTS FILL A SPECIFIC GAP.

IMPORTANT: This is my personal routine, not a prescription. Your needs, health history, medications, team rules, and league testing requirements may be different.

BEFORE PRACTICE OR GAMES

USE TIMING TO SUPPORT THE WORK.

1 TWO TO THREE HOURS BEFORE

BEETROOT / NITRIC-OXIDE SUPPORT

I use a beet product early enough for it to fit the training window. It is not a replacement for conditioning, hydration, or a pre-game meal.

2 THIRTY TO SIXTY MINUTES BEFORE

AMINOS / EAAS

An optional extra serving when food timing or total protein intake needs support.

LEGION PULSE

A caffeinated pre-workout I may use for energy and focus. Know your tolerance and avoid letting caffeine damage sleep.

- [ ] I ate a real meal that supports the session.
- [ ] I know how much caffeine I am taking.
- [ ] I checked this exact product and batch for sport-testing risk.
- [ ] I have used this before and know how my body responds.

DO NOT EXPERIMENT ON GAME DAY: Introduce only one new product at a time and test it during a lower-stakes training day.

PROTECT SLEEP

RECOVERY STARTS BEFORE YOUR HEAD HITS THE PILLOW.

WHAT I USE	MY PURPOSE	HOW IT FITS MY ROUTINE
Apple Cider Vinegar	Meal routine	Something I may use before dinner. It is optional, not a substitute for food quality.
Aminos / EAAs	Protein support	An option when my daily intake or late schedule leaves a gap.
Kion Sleep	Wind-down support	Part of a broader routine that starts with light, temperature, timing, and a consistent bedtime.
Magnesium	Relaxation support	I use it as one part of my nighttime routine after checking the dose and product.
Apigenin	Wind-down support	An optional tool I have used. It should be reviewed with a qualified professional.
Glycine	Sleep routine support	Another optional piece. The routine matters more than the number of supplements.

DARK

Lower lights and screens before bed.

COOL

Make the room comfortable enough to stay asleep.

CONSISTENT

Protect the same sleep window whenever the schedule allows.

PRIORITY: Do not use a supplement to cover a bedtime, caffeine, or screen habit that keeps working against you.

CHOOSE BY NEED

EVERY TOOL NEEDS A JOB.

NORMATEC BOOTS
Compression for heavy legs, travel days, and congested schedules.

GAME READY
Cold plus compression when it is already part of a clinician-led injury or swelling plan.

MASSAGE GUN
A convenient option for short bouts of muscle tension work and warm-up.

HBOT
A high-cost modality that belongs under qualified medical guidance, not casual self-treatment.

RED LIGHT
A recovery modality I may use when access, time, and a clear purpose justify it.

MINI / LONG BANDS
Portable tools for activation, mobility, strength, and returning to movement.

SCRAPERS
Targeted tissue work. Technique and pressure matter more than the tool itself.

BALANCE TOOLS
Foot, ankle, and trunk control work that can fit into a warm-up or rehab plan.

YOGA TOES
A simple option for foot comfort and recovery after long days in basketball shoes.

WEEKLY MASSAGE
Hands-on recovery, relaxation, and a consistent check-in with how the body feels.

SHOP MY RECOVERY + BODY TOOLS → amazon.com/shop/elijahself-improvementjunkie

TRAVEL TEST: Before buying, ask whether the tool is portable, durable, replaceable overseas, and useful enough to earn space in your bag.

MATCH THE TOOL TO THE PROBLEM

DO NOT RECOVER ON AUTOPILOT.

1 NAME THE NEED

- [ ] General fatigue or poor sleep
- [ ] Heavy legs after travel or multiple games
- [ ] Local soreness, swelling, or an active injury
- [ ] Warm-up, activation, or range-of-motion work

2 USE THE LOWEST-COST EFFECTIVE MOVE

- [ ] Sleep, meal, water, walk, or easy mobility first.
- [ ] Add one targeted tool only if it fits the need.
- [ ] Escalate pain, swelling, or injury questions to medical staff.

3 CHECK THE RESULT

What changed after using the tool?

Is it worth repeating?

A RECOVERY TOOL SHOULD SOLVE A PROBLEM, NOT BECOME A RITUAL YOU NEVER QUESTION.

PERSONAL WORKSHEET

START SMALL. TRACK WHAT WORKS.

MY FOUNDATION HABIT

Sleep, food, hydration, or movement:

MY MAIN RECOVERY NEED

The problem I am trying to solve:

ONE SUPPLEMENT

Purpose, timing, dose, and professional approval:

ONE BODY TOOL

When I will use it and what result I expect:

7 SEVEN-DAY CHECK

- [ ] I followed the routine consistently.
- [ ] I noticed a useful change in sleep, readiness, soreness, or energy.
- [ ] The routine was practical during travel and team responsibilities.
- [ ] I can explain why each item is in my stack.

KEEP / CHANGE / REMOVE: _____

CONSISTENCY TEST: A smaller routine you follow is more valuable than a perfect routine that disappears after three days.

PROTECT YOUR HEALTH AND CAREER

YOU ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR WHAT ENTERS YOUR BODY.

These are my personal experiences, not medical advice. Before adding a supplement or recovery modality, speak with a qualified physician, sports dietitian, athletic trainer, or your team's performance staff.

- [ ] Check the current prohibited list and the rules that apply to your league.
- [ ] Use independent sport-testing directories such as NSF Certified for Sport or Informed Sport.
- [ ] Verify the exact product and, when available, the exact batch or lot number.
- [ ] Keep packaging, receipts, lot numbers, and a written record of what you take.
- [ ] Review possible interactions, side effects, doses, and timing with qualified staff.
- [ ] Remember that third-party testing can reduce risk, but it cannot make supplement use risk-free.

WADA DOES NOT APPROVE OR CERTIFY SUPPLEMENTS.

Anti-doping rules apply strict liability: the athlete is responsible for prohibited substances found in their body. Protect your availability, reputation, and career by treating every supplement decision seriously.

SIGN-OFF: Build the foundation. Choose with purpose. Keep showing up. Faith + Consistency.